1874

Peking - 30 July

Mr Wade

No. 156

Aug 10

Recd Oct 18

Mandalay Expedition

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No. 157

Peking

31. July 1874.

My Lord,

In a recent conversation about the present relations of China and Japan, M. de Bützow declared it to be his strong conviction that there will not, in the present case, be war between China and Japan. M. de Bützow has been some two years Minister of Russia in Japan and he perfectly confirms the opinion expressed by Sir Harry Parkes

and

The Earl of Derby

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and others of the great want of seriousness in the Japanese. Except Soyeshima, the Japanese Ambassador, sent hither last year, he knows no one, he says, worthy the name of a Statesman.

M. de Bützow is at the same time greatly dissatisfied with the Chinese and predicts that unless the Chinese undergo a change of which as yet there is not the sign of a commencement, the rising generation in Japan will make Japan

the

the superior power of the two. I have not sufficient knowledge of the latter to affirm or deny this.

I have the honor to be
with the highest respect,
My Lord,
Your Lordship's most obedient,
Humble servant,
Thomas Francis Wade.

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Peking. 31 July 74
Mr Wade.
No 157
Confidential
[illegible]
Russian opinion of Chinese & Japanese.

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The Queen
Ld Derby
Cabinet

Copy to Sir H. Parkes Oct 3.

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No 158

Peking
31. July 1874.

My Lord,

In the conversation reported in the foregoing despatch, I asked M. de Bützow if he had had any news from East Turkestan. He said nothing later than March last. The Ameer Yacoob, of whom M. de Bützow speaks as the Athalik Ghazee, had then recalled one of his sons from thence

The Earl of Derby

which